

MANISH RAJPUT

Jan. 18, 2023

(L-R) **Vinesh Phogat, Sangeeta Phogat, Sakshi Malik along with Bajrang Punia and other wrestlers** come together at Jantar Mantar levelling charges of sexual harassment, stalking, intimidation, demanding sexual favours and financial mismanagement against Singh. The cohort demands his resignation—his tenure was to end only in March—and the dissolution of the WFI

Jan. 19



As former wrestler and BJP member **Babita Phogat** meets the wrestlers and promises to mediate on their behalf, the athletes say they don't want the support of politicians. The same evening, they meet Union sports minister Anurag Thakur at his residence. No resolution is reached

Jan. 21

In a subsequent meeting, Thakur says an Oversight Committee (OC) will be constituted to probe the allegations and that Singh will step aside till the investigation is completed. Wrestlers call off the protest

Jan. 23



Boxer **Mary Kom** is appointed head of the OC. Olympic silver medallist wrestler and BJP leader Yogeshwar Dutt is one of the five members. The OC is given four weeks to finish the probe. A week later, Babita Phogat is added to the OC on the players' request

Apr. 5

The OC submits report to the sports ministry. Said to have recommended a police probe

Apr. 21

Seven women wrestlers, one a minor at the time of the incident, try filing complaints of sexual harassment and criminal intimidation against Singh at Connaught Place police station. But the police does not file FIRs, they say. The protesters ask the ministry to make OC's findings public

Apr. 23

Unhappy with the lack of progress on their allegations, the wrestlers reconvene at Jantar Mantar

June 3



Wrestlers meet Union home minister **Amit Shah** at his residence

June 6

PoCSO complaint withdrawn and a fresh statement under Section 164 of the Criminal Procedure Code is recorded. It is now for the court to decide whether her charges can be pursued or not

June 7

Anurag Thakur meets wrestlers, assures them a chargesheet will be filed by June 15 and that no one from Singh's family will be allowed to contest the WFI election. Wrestlers suspend their protest the next day, and later resume their Railways jobs



June 11

Unfazed by the allegations, Singh leads a massive roadshow in Gonda, part of his Kaiserganj constituency, and declares that he will contest next year's Lok Sabha election

June 15

Delhi Police file sexual harassment chargesheet against Singh under Sections 354 (non-bailable), 354A, 354D and 506 of the IPC; cancellation report submitted in the PoCSO case

It was not as though the wheels of justice were not moving, but they were moving far too slowly. And some of Delhi Police's demands seemed odd

has sole control over an organisation?" Athletes are reluctant to report such incidents for fear of reprisal. "In sports, there is only one employer, so effectively you are dealing with a monopoly. Even if you win, you have to engage with them. You cannot leave and go to another place," the lawyer adds. He equates the strategy the wrestlers adopted to "guerrilla warfare"—akin to the MeToo movement. "If someone doesn't have the resources or the power and the system is stacked against you, you enlarge the size of your voice by doing things that will amplify the message," he says.

In January, the wrestlers had no legal counsel or any idea of what awaited them as they began to reveal their ordeal at Singh's